

SELAMAWIT BEKELE

Principal Software Engineer / Platform

Date of Birth: 9 February 1988

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Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

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PROFILE

Thirteen years building and running distributed systems, the last six at principal level. I have taken three platforms from a single server to multi-region, and I have been on call for all of them. I am most useful where a system is straining and nobody is quite sure why.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer, Platform - Chapa Financial Technologies (Addis Ababa)

July 2022 - Present

- Own the platform group: 11 engineers across three teams
- Led the move from a single Postgres to a sharded setup handling 9,000 writes per second at peak, with no scheduled downtime during the migration
- Introduced an error budget policy; unplanned work fell from roughly 40% of a sprint to under 15%
- Designed the multi-region failover now serving Ethiopia, Kenya and Djibouti
- Stack: Go, Rust, PostgreSQL, Kafka, Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, Datadog

Independent Consultant - various clients (remote)

March 2019 - August 2022

Part-time alongside the Gebeya role until 2021.

- Reliability and scaling engagements for four fintech clients in Kenya, Nigeria and the UAE
- Typical engagement: three months, ending with a runbook and a trained team
- One client's checkout p99 went from 6.1s to 780ms over eleven weeks

Staff Engineer - Gebeya Inc (Addis Ababa)

January 2018 - November 2021

- Rebuilt the talent-matching service; match latency down from 12s to 1.4s
- Introduced the first CI pipeline the company had
- Mentored four engineers to senior level
- Stack: Python, Django, Celery, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker

Senior Software Engineer - Ride (Addis Ababa)

June 2015 - December 2017

- Dispatch and pricing for a ride-hailing service, about 15,000 daily trips
- Built the surge pricing model and the driver payout reconciliation

Software Engineer - Ethiopian Airlines, IT Division (Addis Ababa)

September 2012 - May 2015

- Internal booking and crew-scheduling tools
- Java, Oracle, SOAP services, a lot of legacy

Graduate Trainee - Ethio Telecom (Addis Ababa)

August 2011 - August 2012

- Network operations, rotating placements

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science, Addis Ababa University, 2011 - 2013 (part-time)

BSc Computer Science, Addis Ababa University, 2007 - 2011, Great Distinction

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA), 2021, ID: CKA-2100-4471

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional, 2020

JLPT N4 - Japan Foundation, 2025

PROJECTS

ratelimit-rs - Distributed rate limiter in Rust, used in production at two companies. 1.2k GitHub stars. github.com/sbekele/ratelimit-rs

LANGUAGES

Amharic - Native

English - Fluent, professional

Oromo - Conversational

Japanese - JLPT N4, studying towards N3

SKILLS

Go, Rust, Python, Java, Django, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Oracle, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, GCP, Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, distributed systems, database sharding, SRE, incident response, capacity planning, technical leadership, mentoring, on-call management

AVAILABILITY

Three months' notice. Open to fully remote roles with Japanese companies.

Relocation to Japan possible but not before 2028 for family reasons.

Target compensation: USD 110,000 - 140,000.